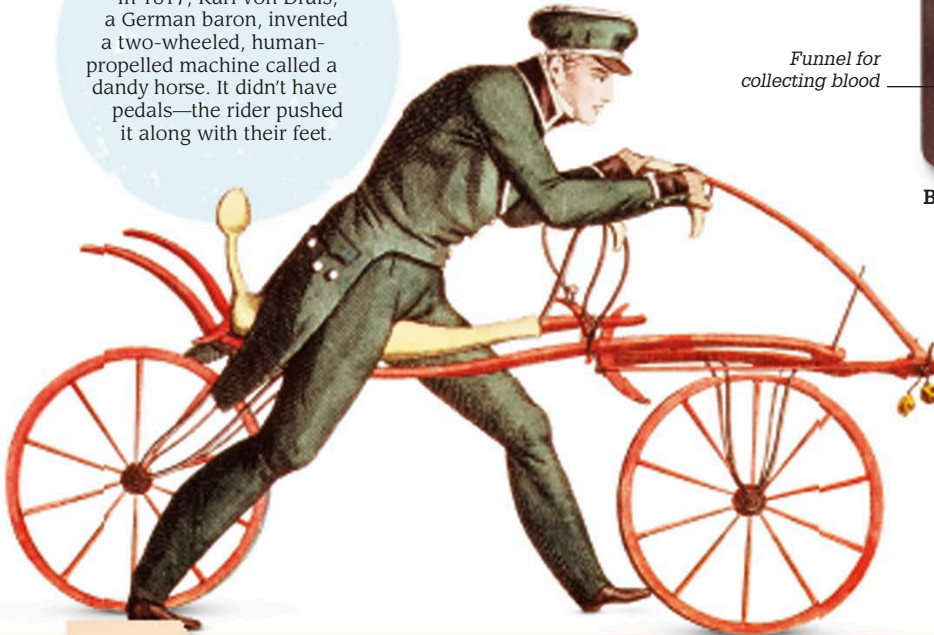


1815 ▶ 1825

Dandy horse

In 1817, Karl von Drais, a German baron, invented a two-wheeled, human-propelled machine called a dandy horse. It didn't have pedals—the rider pushed it along with their feet.



Pump for extracting blood



Funnel for collecting blood

Blundell's blood-transfusion apparatus

1818

Blood transfusion

London doctor James Blundell saved a mother from bleeding to death by taking blood from the arm of a donor and injecting it straight into her arm. It was the first successful human to human blood transfusion. Blundell carried out several more, but the procedure would not become safe until the discovery of blood groups.

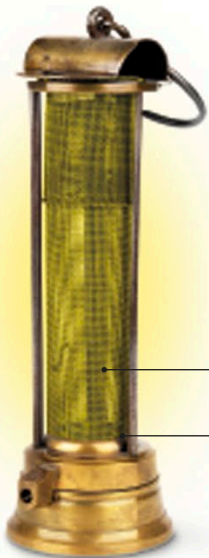


1815

1815

Safety in mines

Coal miners working deep underground constantly risked death because even the smallest spark from the candles they carried might cause a gas explosion. Humphry Davy solved the problem by containing the flame within a cylinder of fine wire mesh. His miners' safety lamp saved thousands of lives.



Flame would burn with a blue tinge in the presence of flammable gases.

Wire mesh allows air to pass through but keeps the flame enclosed.

Miners' safety lamp, c 1815

1819

Listening tube

French doctor René Laennec invented the stethoscope to listen to his patients' lungs and heartbeat—he had felt embarrassed pressing his ear against the chests of his female patients. This first stethoscope was a hollow wooden tube. Doctors have used more advanced stethoscopes ever since to diagnose diseases.

Laennec examines a child with his stethoscope



Healing people
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